



Case Study · Hospitality & Travel · Revenue Strategy

A destination worth arriving at.

A business worth investing in.

How an independent boutique resort broke its OTA dependency, rebuilt its revenue model, and turned guest experience into a growth engine — with **Stralchemistry**.



BACKGROUND

A boutique resort property in a high-tourism region had everything a traveler could want — distinctive architecture, genuine local character, and consistently strong guest reviews. Yet the business behind the experience was under persistent financial pressure. The owners had handed pricing control to OTAs to keep rooms filled, ancillary revenue from F&B and experiences was minimal, and off-peak months were quietly bleeding the property's annual profitability. The founders were exceptional hosts but had never approached their property as a revenue-optimized business.

Stralchemistry was brought in to change that — without stripping the soul from what made the property special.

PAINPOINTS

A structured audit revealed four revenue leaks hiding behind strong occupancy numbers:

OTA stranglehold on margins

82% of bookings came through OTAs at 18-22 % commission. The property was paying to fill its own rooms - and had no direct relationship with the guests it was paying to acquire. Every repeat visitor was effectively a new acquisition cost.

Ancillary revenue untapped

F&B experiences and in-property activities contributed less than 9% of total revenue - far below the industry benchmark. Guests were spending money outside the property that the property was positioned to capture.

Off-peak occupancy collapse

Occupancy swung from near-full in peak season to below 30% in off-peak months. No corporate travel programme, no retreat or event proposition, and no pricing strategy for shoulder seasons - leaving nearly a third of the year commercially inert.

No guest data or retention system

The property had no CRM, no post-stay communication, and no structured way to encourage repeat visits. Guests who loved the property had no bridge back to it - and the property had no way to reach them even if it wanted to.

THE STRALCHEMY ENGAGEMENT

Stralchemy ran a 12-week revenue strategy engagement covering distribution, ancillary monetisation, demand diversification, and guest relationship architecture. The brief was clear from day one — grow revenue without growing costs, and protect the guest experience that made the property worth visiting.

1. Direct Booking Migration Strategy

Stralchemy designed a phased plan to shift bookings from OTAs to the property's own channels — a rebuilt booking engine, a best-rate guarantee with genuine perks, and a targeted email re-engagement campaign to past guests. OTA commissions were replaced by a direct relationship with guests who were now worth more on every subsequent visit.

2. Ancillary Revenue Architecture

A curated experience menu was designed around the property's natural setting and local culture — guided excursions, private dining formats, wellness sessions, and cultural immersion packages. Each was priced as a standalone product and integrated into the booking journey. Ancillary revenue grew from 9% to 28% of total revenue within two quarters.

3. Off-Peak Demand Creation

Stralchemy built two parallel propositions for the low-occupancy window — a corporate offsite and retreat package targeting mid-size companies within driving distance, and a themed slow-travel series for independent travellers seeking off-season value. Both were priced and marketed independently of the peak-season narrative. Off-peak occupancy rose 39% in the first full off-season after launch.

4. Guest Relationship System

Guest relationship system. A lightweight CRM was implemented capturing guest preferences, stay history, and communication consent. A post-stay journey was built — a personalised follow-up, an anniversary prompt, and an early-access offer for returning guests. The property finally had a channel to its own audience that no OTA could own or charge commission on.

OUTCOMES

Direct bookings dominant

Direct bookings share rose from 18% to 61% within 10 months. OTA commission spend fell by ₹38L annually - funds redirected into guest experience and marketing the property owned.

Every guest worth more

Revenue per available room grew 53% through combined yield management and ancillary uptake. The average guest spend per stay increased from ₹8,400 to ₹14,200 - without raising room rates.

Off-peak no longer a loss season

Corporate retreat bookings filled 60% of off-peak inventory in the first cycle. The property's annual revenue profile smoothed from a sharp seasonal spike to consistent year-round curve.

A guest base the property owns

The CRM captured, 2,100 opted-in guest profiles within six months. Repeat visit rate among CRM guests ran at 3.4x the rate of OTA-acquired guests - confirming that owned relationships were structurally more valuable.

“We had built a place people loved to come to. What **Stralchemistry** helped us realize is that we had been giving the value away - to OTAs, to missed experiences, to guests we never stayed in touch with. That changed completely.”

Co-Founder & General Manager, Boutique Resort Property
(Identity withheld at client request)

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